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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: SUICIDAL BEHAVIOR RISK ASSESSMENT AND RELATED RISK FACTORS AMONG COLLEGE STUDENTS AS BASIS FOR A MENTAL HEALTH INTERVENTION PROGRAM DEVELOPMENT	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center	
(4) Site of implementation			
		Municipality/City:	PILAR
		Province:	CAPIZ
		Region:	VI
(5) Classification Research: Development: ☒ Basic ☐ Pilot Testing ☐ Applied ☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization		(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
(7) Sector/Commodity Students/Youth		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Psychology/ Guidance	

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(9A) Abstract (This has a maximum of 250 words. It contains 1-2 sentences of rationale, followed by objectives, brief methodology, major findings, and implications of impact of the study.)

Suicide is a growing mental health problem to which cases worldwide is continuously rising. This study delved on suicidal behavior and related risk factors among college students as input to a mental health intervention program development. Specifically, it focused on: assessing the prevalence of suicidal behavior pattern in terms of suicide attempts and ideation, determine the related risk factors in terms of: personal factors such as age, sex, and course; psychological factors such as anxiety and loneliness; socio-environmental factors such as exposure to bullying and sexual abuse, eventually, identify specific need for action towards development of a relevant mental health intervention program. This study employed 174 college students randomly selected using a multi-stage sampling technique. The research instrument used in this study was adapted from Global School-based Health Survey by World Health Organization and Youth Suicide Risk Assessment Form of Erbacher et al. (2015). Descriptive statistics and cross tabulation utilized to describe and analyze the data. Ethical considerations were strictly observed all throughout the conduct of this study. Results indicated that 21% of the sampled students had suicide ideation without plan and 5% had suicide ideation with plan/intent of suicide. Moreover, 3% had attempted suicide in the last 12 months. Finally, risk factors such as sex, anxiety, loneliness, and sexually abuse were predominantly identified by the students as factors of suicidal ideation and planning. Occurrences of suicide behavior were found to exist among college students hence, addressing these pressing concerns and to reduce the risk of self-inflicted harm within the campus, a well-planned mental health intervention program is hereby recommended.

(9B) Keywords (Write 3-6 words you used in the study, preferably not found in the title because words in the title are already given keywords. This would also include process, or methodology employed.)

Suicidal ideation, suicide attempt, completed suicide, Global School-based Health Survey (GSHS), Youth Suicide Risk Assessment Form

(10) Introduction (This includes the rationale, background of the study, and objectives which are not divided by subheadings. Incorporate at least three (3) reviews)

Suicide is a mental health problem that had become a growing public health concern as it is currently the 11th most common cause of mortality resulting in the loss of approximately one million lives every year (National Institute of Mental Health [NIHM], 2021; World Health Organization [WHO], 2023). It is estimated to contribute to 6% of all deaths worldwide especially among adolescents (Patton, 2009). It is also alarming to note that for every successful suicide committed, more and more people attempted suicide each year. Hence, it is established that prior suicide attempt is the single most important risk factor for suicide in the general population.

A review of the existing literature, most suicide cases happen in middle-low income countries (WHO, 2023; Olson & Frongillo, 2002; Burrows & Laflamme, 2010). Previous research has estimated the prevalence of suicide attempts worldwide with at least 12% in Nigerian adolescents (Peltzer, Cherian, & Cherian, 2000), 4.9% among Canadian youth and between 4.4% –8.1% American adolescents (Swahn & Bossarte, 2007), and 18.8% in the United Kingdom (Kidger et al., 2012). Moreover, studies suggests that suicidal behaviour in terms of suicide attempt and repeated attempts were less than 10% in the majority of studies (Nock et al., 2008; Wichstrom, 2000).

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In the Philippines, Statistics Authority (PSA) reported 25.7% rise in suicide cases in 2020 and continues to rise. According to the report, approximately 5,000 people died by intentional self-harm during the surge of the pandemic in the Philippines. In the province of Capiz, prevalence of suicide, attempted suicide and depression cases have been notable. Capiz Provincial Police Office recorded 36 suicide cases in 2020. Recently, Police Regional Office disclosed Capiz as ranked third in Western Visayas with most number of suicide cases as of September 2021. On a personal note, the researcher who is a guidance counselor designate recorded few cases of suicide attempts and self-harm incidents in campus.

Risk factors such as psychological distress, exposure to bullying and violence, parental involvement and illicit drug abuse have been found to be associated with an increased risk of a suicide attempt (Randall, Doku, Wilson, & Peltzer, 2014). A stress-diathesis model is a possible explanation for why these factors increase the risk of suicide. Since these factors often translate into increased stress, they can lead individuals with the appropriate diathesis traits to turn to suicide as a means of escaping. Most of the research on risk factors for suicide attempts has been done in HEIs in the country but results yield as to the certainty as to which risk factors are most important among college students. Determining which of these factors are relevant can assist in determining interventions better suited for college students. Much of the current epidemiological evidence on the incidence and prevalence of suicidal ideation and suicidal behaviours is based on data from mainly high-income countries. Hence, this current research aimed to explore the suicidal behavior of college students in terms of suicide ideation and attempts, determine the related risk factors of suicidal behavior in terms of personal factors such as age, sex, and course; psychosocial factors such as anxiety and loneliness; and, socio-environmental factors such as exposure to bullying and sexual abuse eventually leading to the development of a mental health intervention program.

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods, duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

This descriptive research study employed 174 samples from 1362 officially enrolled college students during the academic year 2023- 2024 of Capiz State University- Pilar Satellite College. They were randomly selected using a multi- stage sampling technique from among the six programs offered by the campus, namely: Bachelor of Elementary Education, Bachelor of Science in Social Work, Bachelor of Science in Agriculture, Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management.

The research instrument used in this study was taken from the structured questionnaire of the Global School-based Health Survey (GSHS) originally developed by the World Health Organization. The survey contained one question regarding suicidal behaviour and two questions regarding suicidal ideation and planning. These questions were used to derive two categorical outcome variables with three levels in each, one variable for suicidal behaviour and one variable for suicidal ideation and planning. The questions used from the GSHS for the suicidal ideation and planning variable were: "During the past 12 months, did you ever seriously consider attempting suicide?" and "During the past 12 months, did you make a plan about how you would attempt suicide?". Those who responded 'yes' to considering suicide but 'no' to planning were coded as suicidal ideation only (coded as 1) whereas those who responded 'yes' to both were coded as suicidal ideation and planning (coded as 2). Those who responded 'no' to both questions were

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coded as no ideation (coded as 0). For the suicidal behaviour outcome students were asked “During the past 12 months, how many times did you actually attempt suicide?”. Available responses were; “0”, “1”, “2 or 3”, “4 or 5”, and “6 or more times”. These data were recoded so that respondents were grouped into 3 categories; no attempts (coded as 0), 1 attempt (coded as 1) and multiple attempts (coded as 2).” On the other hand, the independent variables were both extracted from the same questionnaire and Youth Suicide Risk Assessment Form of Erbacher et al. (2015). included: age, sex, anxiety, loneliness, bullying, and sexual abuse.

To describe and analyze the gathered data, simple descriptive statistics such as frequency counts and mean scores as well as cross tabulation were used.

Since this investigation deals with a very sensitive issue, the questionnaire was administered by the researcher who is a professional guidance counselor to all eligible participants in an anonymous, voluntary manner. Written permission was obtained from each participant, classroom advisers, and parents. An informed consent form was also discussed with the participants including the extent of their voluntary participation, risks and benefits, confidentiality and the nature and purpose of the study. After each interview, a stress debriefing was carried out by the researcher to ensure processing of possible psycho-emotional effect of this investigation and signing of anti-suicide contract for participants with identified tendencies.

(12) Results and Discussions (This part contains presentation of results (data) with reference to the table and figure, to be followed by discussion, with support of reviewed literature. Sequence shall be based on the objectives of the study. Tables are formatted without the vertical lines. Horizontal lines are set at the top and bottom portions as well as below table headings and above major subdivisions. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

The discussion that follows described the gathered data pertinent to the demographic characteristics of the respondents, their suicidal behavior in terms of suicide ideation and suicide attempt as well as the related risk factors limited to personal factors such as age, sex, and course; psychological factors such as anxiety and loneliness; and socio-environmental factors such as exposure to bullying and sexual abuse.

Demographic characteristics. In terms of demographic characteristics, majority of the sampled college students were between ages 17-20 years old (71%), female (57%) and is taking Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management (28%). It can be noted that most college students were at the height of their youth and still vulnerable. The table that follows presents the data gathered on the demographic characteristics of the respondents.

Table 1. Distribution of respondents according to their demographic characteristics

A. Age		
	Frequency	Percentage
17- 20	123	71%
21- Above	51	29%
	174	100%
B. Sex		
	Frequency	Percentage
Male	75	43%
Female	99	57%
	174	100%
C. Course		
	Frequency	Percentage

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BEED	24	14%
BSIT	33	19%
BSHM	49	28%
BSBA	29	17%
BSA	18	10%
BSSW	21	12%
174	100%	

Suicide Ideation. In terms of suicidal behavior, as summarized in table 2, 74% (129) of the sample college students never thought of suicide, 21% (37) indicated they have thoughts about suicide but with no plan/ or intent to commit suicide while, the remaining 5% (8) have thoughts with plan of suicide. This results revealed that a significant number of college students have suicide ideation though not deliberate on their plans of committing such act but still alarming to note that they have entertained these thoughts. Certain factors may be considered to further understand these occurrences however, this results affirmed the existing literature about suicide prevalence among youth in the general picture (Nock,et al , 2008; Wichstrom, 2000; Alaimo, Olson & Frongillo, 2002; Burrows & Laflamme, 2010; Peltzer, Cherian, & Cherian, 2000; Kidger, Heron, Lewis, Evans, & Gunnell, 2012).

Suicide Ideation and Related Risk Factors. Furthermore, cross tabulation analysis showed that in terms of personal factor such as age, most repondents (69%) belonging to the age range between 17 to 20 years old have no thought of suicide. However, 14% of them have indicated they did have suicide ideation but without plan or intent of carrying the act and another 3% indicated that they have thoughts of suicide and have plan or intent to carry the act.

In terms of sex, it was prominent that male students (57%) have not thought of suicide compared to female students (17%). at any time but 5% of them reported they have actually thought though have no deliberate plan to carry out suicide. And, 4% of them have suicide ideation along with plans/ intent to commit suicide. It was also notable that there were more (16%) female students who reported have thoughts of suicide but with no intent to do so.

In terms of psychological factors, more college students indicated they experienced anxiety (17%) and loneliness (15%) but they did not thought of suicide. However, 10% of college students who experienced anxiety have actually thought of suicide but with no deliberate plan to engage in the act. The results further indicated that 16% of students who experienced anxiety have suicide ideation and plans to commit it. For lonleliness, although majority of college student who experienced loneliness said they have not thought of suicide with 15 % in figure, yet all students who indicated have thoughts of suicide with or without plans have experienced loneliness.

In terms of socio-environmental factors, it was noted that 6% of college students experienced bullying while 2% of them reported they were sexually abused.The table that follows displayed the risk factors among the mentioned groups.

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Table 2. Distribution of Respondents According to Suicide Ideation and its interplay of Related Risk Factors

Suicidal Behavior	No ideation	Ideation without plan	Ideation with plan	Row Total
	% (n)	% (n)	% (n)	
	74% (129)	21%(37)	5%(8)	174
Age				
17-20	69% (121)	14%(24)	3%(5)	88%(153)
20- Above	5% (8)	7%(13)	2% (3)	12%(21)
Sex				
Male	57% (99)	5% (9)	4% (7)	43%(75)
Female	17% (30)	16% (28)	1% (1)	57%(99)
Psychological Factors				
Anxiety	17% (30)	10% (17)	16%(8)	43% (75)
Loneliness	15% (26)	6% (10)	8% (8)	29% (50)
Socio- environmental Factors				
Being Bullied	5% (9)	1% (1)		6% (10)
Sexually Abuse	1%(1)		1%(1)	2% (2)

Suicide attempts. In terms of suicide attempts, the samples respondents were grouped according to whether they indicated they had attempted suicide during the last 12 months. The three groups were no attempts, one attempt, and multiple attempts. Results indicated that 97% (169) of college students did not have any suicide attempts within the previous year, 2%(4) reported making an attempt at least once, and 1%(1) specified had made multiple suicide attempts.

Suicide attempts and Related Risk Factors. Moreover, considering the occurrences of suicide attempts relative to risk factors such as age, it can be noted that ages between 17-20 years old indicated they have not attempted suicide yet 2% of them stated they did attempted suicide at least once or more. In terms of sex, it can be noted that there were more male who reported they attempted suicide at least once than female.

In terms of psychological factors, among those who reported they experienced anxiety (43%) had said they have not attempted suicide (40%) while 2% reported they did attempted suicide at least once and even multiple times. This results was also true to loneliness, where out of 50 respondents who reported they experienced loneliness at least 3 % said they attempted suicide at least once or more.

For the socio-environmental factors, there were only few (6%) the sampled respondents who experienced bullying displayed suicidal behavior in terms of attempt to which only 1% indicated he did had an attempt at least once. On the hand, for sexual abuse a little 2% reported they experienced sexual abuse 1% said had no suicide attempt while 1% indicated had tried killing himself multiple times. The table that follows (Table 3) presents the distribution of college students in three groups across the related risk factors identified.

Table 3. Distribution of Respondents According to Suicide Attempt and its interplay with Related Risk Factors

Suicide attempts	No attempt	At least 1 attempt	Multiple attempts	Row Total
	% (n)**	% (n)**	% (n)**	
	97% (169)	2%(4)	1%(1)	174
Age				
17-20	86% (150)	1%(2)	1%(1)	71%(153)

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20- Above	11% (19)	1%(2)		29%(21)
Sex				
Male	41% (73)	1% (2)	1% (1)	43%(75)
Female	56% (98)	1% (1)		57%(99)
Psychological Factors				
Anxiety	40% (70)	2% (4)	1%(1)	43% (75)
Loneliness	26% (45)	2% (4)	1% (1)	29% (50)
Soco- Environmental Factors				
Being Bullied	5% (5)	1% (1)		6% (10)
Sexually Abuse	1%(1)		1%(1)	2% (3)

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations (This part shall be written in narrative form and arranged based on the objectives and findings. Conclusions are general statements answering the objectives. Recommendations are based on the conclusions. They may be split or combined based on their length, which means, conclusions and recommendations may be split under separate headings if they are long. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Suicidal behaviors in terms of suicide ideation and suicide attempts are relatively occurring in the college campus. The young age college students are more prone to suicide ideation and attempt. Male students are more prominent to suicide attempt than female although female students are more prone to suicide ideation. Risk factors such as anxiety and loneliness are prevailing factors for suicide ideation and attempts. Hence, prevention through possible mental health programs maybe developed to alleviate negative feelings that lead to suicidal ideation. Greater emphasis on guidance and counseling programs particularly on counseling student's at risk may be encouraged for timely intervention as well as strengthening peer support group within the campus for a socially healthy school environment as well as to increase accessible level of support which could have a lasting consequences for the mental health of college students.

(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

A module on Mental Health Intervention Program through Group Support System (MIGSS) was developed based on the results of the study as a number of college students were identified as relatively at-risk suicidal. MIGSS aimed to promote positive mental health through group dynamics, social support system while providing students an opportunity to gain knowledge, discover, enhance and showcase their hidden talent and skills. The program provides necessary training and social activities that promote positive social skills, values, attitude and outlook while gaining friends and finding support group.

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

Enhanced Guidance and Counseling Program through Mental Health Intervention Program through Group Support System (MIGSS)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

None

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

The researcher is wholeheartedly indebted to the following people and institution whose significant contribution had made this study possible. Firstly, the Capiz State University Pilar Satellite College Administration and Research and Development and

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Extension (RDE) for the trust and support extended. Secondly, the Philippine National Police- Pilar Municipal Headquarter headed by P/Maj Alfred De Leon for the assistance and providing the needed statistics of suicide cases in the municipality of Pilar and in the Capiz province in general. Finally, the College students of CapSU Pilar for the active involvement as respondents of this study.

(18) References (It should include only works mentioned in the text and should be arranged alphabetically. Citations shall not be less than 13 entries. This must follow the APA latest edition format, in hanging indentation with 12-point space in between.)

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